

Cuba

The largest island in the Caribbean Sea, Cuba is made up of mountains, rolling hills, and flat plains. It is very fertile and rich in nickel, cobalt, and other minerals.

Cigars

Cuba's warm days and cool nights are ideal for growing tobacco, which is cut, dried, and rolled to make the world-famous Cuban cigars.

Would you like sugar?

It's it a Cuban cube?

Sugar cane

Sugar and its many by-products account for half of Cuba's total exports, along with coffee, tobacco, fish, and minerals.

Jamaica

The English-speaking island of Jamaica is rich in minerals—it is the world's fourth largest producer of bauxite—and has a fertile landscape with beautiful beaches.

Trie, mon.

Rastafarians

The Rastafarian religion began in Jamaica in the 1930s. Rastafarians believe that God will lead black people home to the promised land of Ethiopia.

Fore!

Puerto Rico

Spanish-speaking Puerto Rico has been a U.S. territory since 1898, and many U.S. companies produce cheap goods here to sell back home.

Population

Puerto Rico has one of the highest population densities in the world, with 3.8 million people living tightly packed on the island.

Stop crowding me!

I'm cruisin' through life.

Bahamas

The island chain of the Bahamas lies northeast of Cuba in the Atlantic Ocean, and is a wealthy financial center. Only 30 of the 700 islands are inhabited.

Tourism

More than 40 percent of the Bahamas' population works in the tourist industry, mainly servicing the many cruise liners that visit the islands.

Panama

Long, thin Panama is the most southerly country in Central America, forming a land link to South America. Its climate is hot and humid with heavy rainfall, enabling a wide range of crops to be grown in its fertile soil.

Panama Canal

The Panama Canal is an important sea route between the Atlantic and Pacific oceans.

Shared island

The island of Hispaniola is shared by two nations—Haiti (the first independent nation in the Caribbean) in the west and the Dominican Republic in the east.

I can't see the forest for the trees.

Missed!

Tree loss

Both nations suffer from deforestation, as trees are cut down for firewood or to clear the ground for agriculture.

Windward Islands

The seven island groups of the Windwards are mainly hilly and very fertile, with Grenada being one of the major spice-producing nations in the world.

I've got a pounding headache.

FINISH

Cricket

The British introduced cricket to the West Indies, where it is now a major sport.

Steel-pan drums

Providing music for Trinidad's annual carnival, the steel-pan drums were invented on the island.

Who's paying?

Let's go Dutch.

St. Martin

Split between French and Dutch rule, St. Martin's people speak two languages and use two currencies.

Montserrat

The Soufrière Hills volcano exploded on Montserrat in 1997, making two-thirds of the island uninhabitable.

Leeward Islands

A mixture of independent nations and British, French, Dutch, and U.S. colonies, the Leeward Islands are so-called because they are in the "lee" of the Windward Islands that shelter them from the prevailing winds.

Tourism

With its fine beaches and cheap hotels, the Dominican Republic is the Caribbean's most popular tourist destination.